

Company	WITTE Automotive GmbH (Velbert, NRW)
HQ	Velbert, North Rhine-Westphalia
Revenue	>€1 billion (Vast Automotive Group; 4th-generation family-owned)
Employees	~6,000 worldwide; 9 countries
Axians relationship	No known Axians relationship — cold account. NRW regional proximity is an advantage.

Why This Account. Why Now.

- Leiter IT Security role created January 2024 — same month TISAX 6.0 was published and NIS2 preparation was peaking
- Tier 1 automotive supplier to VW, BMW, Mercedes, Stellantis — OEM auditors require documented production network segmentation
- Mechatronic locking systems = cyber-physical products; production floor = OT/IT convergent environment
- CTO Christian Kaczmarczyk left July 2025 — technology leadership in transition; 'assess everything' mode
- No known Illumio or other segmentation vendor — first-mover opportunity

The Narrative

Rainer Schulten spent 25 years building Witte's IT infrastructure. He knows every gap. In January 2024, he accepted the security mandate — which means he's now accountable for the segmentation that TISAX 6.0 and NIS2 both require. The first call is about what VW's last supplier security questionnaire said about network segmentation — not about Guardicore.

Primary Contact

Name	Rainer Schulten
Title	Leiter IT Security, WITTE Automotive (LinkedIn verified — role created January 2024)

The Ask

LinkedIn connection to Rainer Schulten via Axians IT Security NRW AE. Message angle: what OEM auditors are requiring in 2026 for production network segmentation documentation. Goal: a 30-minute discovery call on current TISAX compliance challenges. Follow-up ask: 30-day production network discovery at one Velbert plant.

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